

and that will give you a rough idea about their sturdiness. Many of these companies also make videos to back their claims, so you can watch those as well. However, videos can always be doctored, so look for genuine user reviews online.

COMMON CASE MATERIALS

1. Aluminium – Aluminium cases offer good rigidity and protection but they do provide less impact protection in comparison to other materials.
2. Rubber / Silicone / Gel – These make basic cases that are soft and flexible with excellent grip. However, they don't provide the best protection.
3. TPU / Polycarbonate – Most protective cases use this material since it provides great impact resistance. Often companies will layer multiple layers of these materials to provide enhanced protection.
4. Leather – These cases provide a more premium look but they can be more slippery than polycarbonate or rubber cases. They're also more expensive and bulkier.

SCREEN PROTECTORS SAVE DISPLAYS

Many of us would relate to the trauma of having a cracked screen. In some cases, having the display replaced for an original one could even cost more than the current value of a phone! Good screen protectors can often save your display glass from cracking even if it takes a particularly nasty tumble. Of course, they also protect smartphone screens from getting scratched, which not only looks unsightly but also reduces the resale value of your device. Be it tablets, smartphones, or laptops, it is always a good idea to invest in a screen guard. After all, "glass is glass. And glass breaks". Bonus points for anyone who knows whose line that is. Let's take a look at the various types of screen guards you can purchase.

1. PET (Polyethylene Terephthalate)

Polyethylene Terephthalate or PET is a kind of plastic that is used to

make water bottles or small food containers. They provide very little scratch and impact resistance but they're cheap to produce. So, you may find these under ₹200 – ₹300.

2. TPU (Thermoplastic Polyurethane)

TPU or Thermoplastic Polyurethane is a more flexible plastic material that can be used with curved displays but they can be quite troublesome to install. You have to use a spray solution and squeegee for the bubbles, which isn't the easiest process. It has better impact resistance than PET and does "self-heal" some small scratches.

3. Tempered glass screen protector

These are one of the more popular types of screen protectors especially since they are tougher to scratch and provide more drop resistance. They're also pretty inexpensive these days. These are also pretty anti-reflective. However, those who have phones with ultrasonic fingerprint sensors shouldn't purchase tempered glass protectors since the feature doesn't work through the thick glass. You can choose either PET or TPU glass protectors for those types of phones.

You also have specialised screen protectors for different use cases such as anti-glare screen guards, privacy



Tempered glass screen protector

screen guards, and mirror screen guards. Some companies that have a good collection of high-quality screen guards include Tech Armor, Spigen, IQShield, ZAGG, Maxboost, and ESR.

IS GADGET INSURANCE WORTH IT?

So far, we've spoken about some of the few accessories you can purchase to protect your beloved gadgets from biting the dust. Another way to protect your devices is gadget insurance. Some companies offer up the option of buying gadget insurance alongside the purchase of the device itself, but you can also buy insurance separately from a third party. Gadget insurance usually covers loss, theft or damage to the device. However, the level of cover completely depends on your plan and the terms and conditions of your policy. The important question here is whether gadget insurance is even worth it.

We'll try to answer that. First off, gadget insurance can usually only be purchased for new items and not refurbished or second-hand ones. Now, if you have a new gadget, first you must find out the price of the insurance being offered to you for a year. If your phone costs around as much as you will spend on insurance, it's probably not worth it. However, for a premium phone, it would make sense to pay the comparatively small cost per month, since just the price of repairs can cost as much as a brand new budget phone.

So, we would advise you to research, look for several options, think about if it's worth the amount you would spend in 2-3 years and then go ahead with the decision of buying gadget insurance. **d**

WACKY CASES YOU MUST CHECK OUT!

1. **Thumbs Up Ear Case** – Why would you want this? But then again, why wouldn't you?
2. **Hana Nose Picking Case** – Don't pick your own nose, pick this case's nose!
3. **Gameboy Case** – Can't get enough of retro video games? Flip your phone over and play some!
4. **Dbrand Teardown Case** – These teardown cases, created in collaboration with JerryRigEverything, are a tech enthusiast's dream!
5. **Bubble Popping Case** – The ultimate fidget toy case that looks pretty cool too.